



LEVERAGING YOUR STRENGTHS | EXERCISE 1

Identifying your core Strengths Self-Evaluation

Core Strengths

List the top 5 core strengths you have identified in yourself:

Do you leverage this strength in your work?

- | | | |
|----------|----|-----|
| 1. _____ | No | Yes |
| 2. _____ | No | Yes |
| 3. _____ | No | Yes |
| 4. _____ | No | Yes |
| 5. _____ | No | Yes |

ACTIONS: What actions could you take to develop your strengths further?

Weaknesses

List 5 weaknesses you have identified in yourself:

How does each weakness negatively impact your work?

- | | |
|----------|-------|
| 1. _____ | _____ |
| 2. _____ | _____ |
| 3. _____ | _____ |
| 4. _____ | _____ |
| 5. _____ | _____ |

ACTIONS: What actions you could take to mitigate these weaknesses?



LEVERAGING YOUR STRENGTHS | BEST PRACTICE

Strengths-Based Development

The traditional approach to development suggested that if we are already good at something, then we simply maintain our strengths and work on our weaknesses.

But what if we studied what is right with people versus what's wrong with people?

Recent thinking suggests that a person's most direct path to individual growth and improvement begins with a primary investment in his or her greatest talents.



TALENT

A natural way of thinking, feeling or behaving.



INVESTMENT

Time spend practicing, developing your skills and building your knowledge base.



STRENGTH

The ability to consistently provide near-perfect positive performance.

"There is nothing wrong with being aware of our weaknesses and managing them, but our greatest opportunity for success lies in building on our natural talents."

Donald Clifton

When people have the opportunity to use their greatest talents and strengths, they...



Experience positive energy



Are more likely to achieve their goals



Are more confident



Perform better at work



Are more engaged at work



Experience less stress

People who focus on using their strengths are:

6x

more likely to be engaged in their jobs

12%

more productive

3x

more likely to report a good quality of life

Focus on Your Strengths, Manage Your Weaknesses

ACHIEVING EXCELLENCE

Generally, the best method of achieving excellence is to:

01

Identify a person's talents and weaknesses.

02

Focus development primarily on a person's talents.

03

Manage areas of weakness.

MANAGING WEAKNESSES

Generally, the best method of managing weaknesses is to:



Know your weaknesses and understand how they get in the way.



Collaborate: Ask colleagues for help and support.



Use one of your strengths to achieve a better outcome.



Just do it! By doing your best.

TOOLS



Use CliftonStrengths to understand your core talents and strengths:
www.gallup.com/cliftonstrengths



Seek feedback from peers, colleagues and managers.